

The IT Provider Accountability Checklist

Ten questions you should be able to ask any IT provider — your current one or your next one — and get a clear, documented answer. If a question gets a vague answer twice, you've found the gap.

CLOSURE & COMMUNICATION

- ☐ 1. Who confirms a ticket is done — you, or us? *Good: a ticket closes only when the person who raised it confirms the fix.*
- ☐ 2. Can we see every open ticket, its owner, and its status in plain English? *Good: a live list you can read without translation.*
- ☐ 3. Who is on our account — a named team, or whoever picks up? *Good: the same small pod every time, so staff never re-explain history.*
- ☐ 4. What do we receive monthly that a non-technical leader can read? *Good: a plain-language report — what happened, what it means, what's next.*

ROOT CAUSE & RECOMMENDATIONS

- ☐ 5. When the same issue comes back, what changes? *Good: a recurring issue triggers a root-cause review — not a third quick fix.*
- ☐ 6. Are recommendations written down — problem, fix, investment, owner, date? *Good: a tracked list, reviewed until done. Advice shouldn't evaporate.*
- ☐ 7. What evidence shows our machines are patched, backed up, and protected? *Good: documented proof on a schedule — not "trust us."*

PLANNING AHEAD

- ☐ 8. When do we sit down with leadership to review the whole picture? *Good: a standing quarterly review — without you having to ask for it.*
- ☐ 9. If we move offices, who owns the IT side — and when do circuits get ordered? *Good: a written plan scheduled backward from move day; circuits first (30–60+ days lead).*
- ☐ 10. Are we right-licensed — including nonprofit pricing where we qualify? *Good: an annual licensing review that finds savings before you ask.*

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